

Haliaeetus leucocephalus

long, sharp
bill hook

Life Cycle
There are many species of toucans, including the toucan, the fish eagle, and the eagle. The toucan is a brood bird, and the eagle is a species of bird.

Non
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Fish form a large part of the bald eagle's diet, but it also eats other prey. Bald eagles can catch and kill animals as large as sea otters and birds up to the size of a goose. In summer, many live on seabirds caught in coastal colonies. They are primarily birds of

Bald eagles feed in small groups in winter if enough food is available, and nest in small defended territories, covering about $\frac{3}{4}$ sq mile (0.2sq km). These sites can be grouped quite close together. Nests are built almost anywhere from near-flat ground to small slopes, cliffs, exposed crags, and trees.

Each pair of bald eagles usually has several nests—one preferred nest, a huge heap of sticks, grass, and seaweed, can become as large as 13 ft (4m) deep and 8 ft (2.5m) across. Although two eggs are the norm, usually only one chick survives to fly. Up to three-quarters of the young die before they are a year old, and only one in ten reaches five years of age. Bald eagles can start breeding when four years old. However, unusually, half the adults are non-breeders and some form trios at one nest. Once grown, adults may go on to live long, productive lives, surviving for almost 50 years in the wild.



North America

The **bald eagle** was chosen
as the **national bird of the**
US in 1782